communists and was concerned about internal communism in India. He also vehemently opposed the idea of an independent Kashmir.[21] Willi Nedou, Begum Jehan Abdullah's uncle, who was Sheikh Abdullah's Liaison Officer in Paris, had told the British that Abdullah was seeking Soviet support for his dream.[22] The state department interpreted Malik's speech within the framework of Soviet aims of laying the groundwork for an eventual communist coup in Kashmir. Further, they believed that the Soviets were clandestinely supporting the Chinese campaign in Kashgar of 'liberating' Gilgit and Ladakh. The aim was to create a circle of red in an almost unbroken line from Indo-China to Afghanistan.[23]

Nehru's Disillusionment with Abdullah

Meanwhile, Nehru was also trying to contain the rebellious Abdullah. On 17 June 1952, a National Conference delegation led by Mirza Afzal Beg, including D. P. Dhar and Mir Qasim, all of whom were the communists/crypto-communists in the Abdullah regime, arrived in New Delhi for talks with Nehru. Exactly a month later, on 17 July 1952, Abdullah joined in accompanied by Bakshi Ghulam Mohammed, G. M. Sadiq and Maulana Masoodi. On 24 July 1952, an agreement was reached between Abdullah's group and Nehru. This is often referred to as the Delhi Accord, and this was the third accord on the future of the state; the first accord was the Instrument of Accession and the second accord was the replacement of the Maharaja by the Regent.

Abdullah was now emphatic that the state, while it was a part of the Indian Union, also enjoyed certain unique privileges within that union. Most important was the issue of landownership and he insisted on ensuring that the citizens of the state had rights relating to landownership which were denied to Indian citizens from outside the state. The exceptional authority of the constituent assembly was recognised. The power of the President of India to declare a state of emergency could only be exercised in the state at the request or with the concurrence of the state government. The state